Universal Human Values — II · 21LEM202T

Unit 3 · Session 8 · SLO 2 — Solved Worksheet

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Unit – 3 : Session – 8 | Limits to Growth and the Real Problem

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

• Q1. 'LIMITS TO GROWTH' (1972, Club of Rome) was a landmark computer-simulation study (World3 model at MIT) that showed: if growth trends in population, industrialisation, pollution, food production and resource depletion continue unchanged, the limits to growth on this planet will be reached within a hundred years, followed by decline. Its key message: unlimited material growth on a finite planet is impossible — the 'growth forever' assumption itself must be questioned. It was one of the first scientific warnings that the dominant development model is unsustainable.

• Q2. 'The problem is NOT JUST POPULATION' means: a large population WITH right understanding can live prosperously within nature's limits (assessed needs, right utilisation, cyclical production), while even a small population WITHOUT right understanding — with unlimited consumption, exploitation and domination — destroys the planet (e.g., the richest 10% consume the majority of resources). The real variable is the human ASSUMPTION and conduct, not headcount alone. Hence population control without human education cannot solve the crisis; the number matters far less than the manner of living.

• Q3. SYMPTOMATIC approaches to sustainability: carbon offsets that let consumption continue, fines for polluters that are cheaper than compliance, green marketing without redesigning production — all treat the surface. SAMADHAN approaches: (1) clarity that inhuman conduct (assumption 'physical facility is everything') is the root cause; (2) effort through human education, human conduct, human constitution and human order; (3) analysing each problem in the light of that clarity; (4) ensuring conduct through education. The first set manages symptoms; the second set eliminates the cause.

• Q4. FIVE personal actions toward the solution: (1) RIGHT UTILISATION — assess my real needs and consume only that much (no impulse buying, minimal food waste). (2) CYCLICAL PRACTICE — segregate waste, compost organics, reuse and recycle so my consumption returns to nature's cycle. (3) RESOURCE RESTRAINT — save water and electricity deliberately (bucket bath, switching off, harvesting rainwater where possible). (4) PARTICIPATION — plant and nurture trees, support local natural farming and community initiatives. (5) SELF-EXPLORATION — daily examine my desires: are they from sensation/preconditioning or natural acceptance? — so that my conduct stays guided by right understanding rather than market-driven want.